



Tandy Corporation

News Release

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TANDY CORPORATION ANNOUNCES MAJOR BREAKTHROUGH IN OPTICAL MEDIA: TANDY THOR-CD™, THE FIRST CD-COMPATIBLE RECORD & ERASE TECHNOLOGY

NEW YORK CITY--Tandy Corporation announced today a revolutionary development in optical disc media: TANDY THOR-CD™. With the introduction of TANDY THOR-CD technology, it is now possible to record and erase digital information on a CD-compatible optical disc.

Using a laser beam, TANDY THOR-CD can repeatedly record, playback, store and erase music, data or video on a disc that can be used with all existing CD audio and CD-ROM players.

Just as important, TANDY THOR-CD will be an inexpensive media. It is expected to be less expensive than alternate digital audio formats, including digital audio tape (DAT).

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"TANDY THOR-CD will have applications in several fields of electronics," stated John V. Roach, President, CEO and Chairman of the Board of Tandy Corporation.

"TANDY THOR-CD's commercialization in audio should be rapid, its applicability in mass memory is long sought after, and it may have video applications as well."

TANDY THOR-CD playback technology follows the same technique used in conventional optical discs: using a laser beam to read a series of microscopic pits in a light reflecting disc.

What makes TANDY THOR-CD the technological breakthrough in optical media is that the pits, while environmentally stable and permanent in nature, can be erased, allowing editing and re-recording, over and over again.

Because the optically-formed pits resemble those in a conventional, molded CD in fit, form and function, TANDY THOR-CD retains all of the extraordinary qualities of current CDs.

TANDY THOR-CD Technology is the result of years of research and development at the Tandy Magnetic Media Research Center in Santa Clara, California. Exhaustive testing has confirmed TANDY THOR-CD's ability to record, erase and play back digital information that is virtually indistinguishable from the original source material.

What's more, erasing a previously recorded signal instantaneously returns the media to its original state, ready for the next recording.

"For several reasons," according to Robert McClure, President of Tandy Electronics Manufacturing, "the first commercial use of TANDY THOR-CD will be CD-audio. We believe there is a present and substantial market for a recordable CD-audio disc. CD-audio is also the least demanding on the hardware and the media. The additional cost in electronics and drive mechanisms should permit play and record decks to be offered in the early years of development for under \$500."

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"The next likely commercial product," continued McClure, "is a data storage device which requires greater precision and error checking capabilities. TANDY THOR-CD technology will fit well in the high-density storage field with storage capabilities in the hundreds of megabytes per five-inch disc."

The access time relating to TANDY THOR-CD is comparable to CD technology, so there is no difference in access time or data transfer rates between TANDY THOR-CD and CD-audio and CD-ROM.

"In a practical sense," added McClure, "optical disc access times are comparable to floppy discs. Access times projected for the future are even more encouraging. With access time being a function of equipment, rather than media, new development of extremely low-mass holographic heads show promise of dramatically reducing access times comparable to that of hard discs."

"Tandy," stated Roach, "is actively working with key electronics innovators around the world to license this technique for use in hardware and for production of media. The likelihood that very low cost mechanisms to implement the technique will be developed makes it highly attractive."

Organizations interested in participating in the development and production of TANDY THOR-CD™ Technology should contact TANDY THOR-CD Technologies, 1300 One Tandy Center, Fort Worth, Texas 76102. Telephone: (817) 390-3693.

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